When Worlds Collide: A Literary Linked Open Data Model Critiqueathon (Workshop)

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The workshop *When Worlds Collide: A Literary Linked Open Data Model Critiqueathon* invites participants from the field of Computational Literary Studies to engage in a half-day critique session dedicated to ontologies and data models for literature. By leveraging the format of a hackathon and the open discussion ethos of a bar camp, this "critiqueathon" seeks to foster a culture of honest, constructive critique. Participants will explore and challenge assumptions about how key concepts in literary studies—such as the "Literary Work," "Author," "Genre," "Interpretation," and "Features of a Literary Text"—are represented in competing data models, striving for greater clarity and cross-model understanding and sets impulses for further community-based and network-orientated development Through creative and interactive pedagogical settings, this workshop aims to push the boundaries of ontology development, promote interdisciplinary exchange, and address the fragmented state of data modeling in literary studies.

In line with the conference motto of "Promoting Openness and Collaboration", and considering the definition of ontologies as "shared conceptualizations" (Gruber 1995), it is evident that no shared ontology is currently widely in use in Computational Literary Studies.

Nevertheless, several proposals for ontologies in the field have been put forward (Diez Platas et al. 2021; Hinzmann et al. 2024; Oberreither 2019; Pannach et al. 2024). In designing ontologies, there are tendencies and competing systems or approaches to modelling, for example the opposition between an event based approach to modeling aligned with the CIDOC CRM and compatible models, i.e. the LRMoo versus projects relying on Wikibase and its inherent data model.

The idea of this workshop for the participants is to leave the world of their own data model and try to immerse themselves into someone else's model to find common ground for data modeling in the field of Computational Literary Studies.

Objectives

1. **Critique Data Models:** Provide a structured yet dynamic forum to critique existing literary studies data models and ontologies in depth.
2. **Foster Perspective Shifts:** Encourage participants to engage with and interpret ontologies other than their own, broadening their understanding of diverse modeling approaches.
3. **Identify Trends and Gaps:** Examine tendencies, trends, and gaps in current modeling practices, particularly around event-based approaches (e.g., CIDOC CRM and LRMoo) or Wikibase-centric models.
4. **Explore Interoperability:** Assess the potential for compatibility and mapping between

competing systems, identifying practical steps toward bridging conceptual divides.

5. **Cultivate Critical Dialogue:** Establish an honest and productive critique culture within the computational literary studies community.

Format and Schedule

First Session: Critique Through Immersion

Introduction and Orientation (15 minutes):
Overview of the workshop goals, structure, and expectations. Participants briefly introduce their data models and highlight one challenge or issue they face.

Interactive Critique Method: "PowerPoint Karaoke" (45 minutes):
Each participant receives another's data model or ontology to study briefly. They must then present it to the group as if it were their own, emphasizing its strengths and limitations.

- *Goal*: Encourage empathy and fresh perspectives by forcing participants to engage deeply with unfamiliar models.
- *Outcome*:
  - Surface implicit assumptions and biases in modeling approaches.
  - Show opportunities and limits of model/ontology documentation and pathways to improvement.

Discussion: Learning Through Critique (15 minutes):
Facilitated group discussion reflecting on the insights gained from the exercise. What surprised participants about their own or others' models? What commonalities or conceptual tensions emerged?

Second Session: Finding Common Ground and Productive Tensions

Breakout Groups: Deep Dives into Key Concepts (45 minutes):
Participants split into groups to explore and discuss specific aspects of literary data modeling, such as:

- Modeling the "Literary Work"
- Representing "Authorship" and "Agency"
- Assigning "Genre"
- Capturing textual features
- Balancing precision and interoperability in metadata standards.

Reconvene: Group Presentations (30 minutes):
Each break out group shares key insights emerging from their discussion, present their ideas and receive feedback, emphasizing strengths, weaknesses, and potential mappings to other models.

Mapping the Landscape: Synthesis Discussion (30 minutes):
Participants collectively identify patterns of compatibility and points of fundamental difference between models. The focus is on exploring whether mechanisms for cross-model mapping and translation can be developed.

Involved Projects and Initiatives

The workshop builds upon a loose network of people involved in the creation of data models for Computational Literary Studies:

- CLS INFRA (EU Horizon 2020 Project "Computational Literary Infrastructures", https://clsinfra.io)
- DraCor (Drama Corpora Project, https://dracor.org)
- GOLEM (ERC Starting Grant funded project "Graphs and Ontologies for Literary Evolution Models", https://https://golemlab.eu)
- INTRO ("The Intertextual, Interpictorial, and Intermedial Relations Ontology", https://github.com/BOberreither/INTRO)
- LODinG ("Linked Open Data in den Geisteswissenschaften" ["LOD in the Humanities"], https://tcdh.uni-trier.de/de/projekt/loding)
- MiMoText ("Mining and Modeling Text", https://mimotext.uni-trier.de)
- POSTDATA ("Poetry Standardization and Linked Open Data", https://postdata.linhd.uned.es)

Intended Audience

This workshop is designed for researchers, developers, and practitioners in Computational Literary Studies, and everyone else involved in creating or using ontologies, metadata standards, and linked data models in the Literary Studies (i.e. digital librarians, database maintainers, research data curators). Participants should have a working knowledge of ontology design and be willing to critique and be critiqued. Participants are encouraged to provide documentation (e.g. a graphical representation of their data model) and/or a presentation prior to the workshop.

Didactic Innovations

The *Critiqueathon* format prioritizes interaction and creative engagement over traditional presentations. By using methods like "PowerPoint Karaoke," the workshop disrupts the conventional conference format, forcing participants to adopt new perspectives on familiar problems. Group discussions and structured critique encourage dialogue that is rigorous yet collaborative, laying the groundwork for productive intellectual collisions.

Expected Outcomes

1. A clearer understanding of competing literary data models, their strengths, and limitations.
2. Identification of shared concepts and critical divergences in modeling approaches.
3. Practical proposals for addressing interoperability challenges.
4. Strengthened community ties and a commitment to fostering a more unified approach to data modeling in the Computational Literary Studies and beyond.

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